



Every Child, Every Day, Whatever it Takes

TO: Evanston/Skokie District 65 School Board

CC: Dr. Angel Turner, Superintendent

FROM: Dr. Stacy Beardsley, Asst. Superintendent, Kirby Callam, Director of Strategic Project Management

DATE: July 23, 2025

RE: Property Assessment Profile - Approval Request

Objective: ☐ Information ☐ Discussion ☐ Follow-up ☒ Decision

During the spring of 2025, the facilities SDRP Phase III subcommittee engaged in a collaborative process to develop categories and criteria to be used to develop school scorecards and inform potential school closure or consolidation scenarios. In the Financial Impact: Building Income category, the subcommittee wants to capture income potential of District 65 school buildings/sites. As the District considers options for possible school closure and consolidation, it is critical to assess the financial and planning implications of retaining, repurposing, or selling existing school properties. This includes estimating market value, development potential, and long-term public benefit of each site under different scenarios and funding environments.

To accurately capture income potential of District 65 property a Request for Proposals (RFP) was issued to seek a qualified real estate development/advisory firm to generate informed property assessment profiles.

These School Property Profiles (SPP) will assist the Facility subcommittee in evaluating future use and value of school properties as part of its Structural Deficit Reduction Process (SDRP) Phase III.

District 65 will incorporate the SPPs to guide decision-making for school closure and consolidation scenarios for the use, redevelopment, or disposition of school sites based on financial, regulatory, and strategic factors evaluated along three use-case scenarios*:

1. Keep

- Short-term rental/leasing potential
- Estimated operational and maintenance costs
- Public benefits of continued school/district use

2. Re-use

- Redevelopment feasibility (e.g., affordable or mixed-income housing, civic reuse)
- Potential for public-private partnerships or grant-supported projects
- Long-term financial return and community benefit

3. Sell

- Estimated market value
- Likely buyers and comparable transactions
- Financial impact of a one-time sale

In addition to these core assessments, each SPP will consider a range of additional factors that may influence future decisions. These include the public benefit provided under different use scenarios, compatibility with District 65's long-term facility needs, and any constraints such as existing zoning regulations, historic designations, or site-specific infrastructure or access issues. SPPs will also include a location-based analysis, evaluating each site's viability for retention or redevelopment based on neighborhood commercial and housing characteristics, demographic trends, and real estate market conditions.

The timeline for completion to develop the School Property Profiles will be from mid-July to September 4, 2025. The Facility subcommittee will incorporate the SPPs within its school closure scenario evaluations specifically when scoring the *Building Income* criterion. The Committee is charged with bringing viable scenarios forward for consideration. All decisions regarding school closures/consolidations and property use are that of the School Board.

Recommendation:

The Request for Proposal process began in June 2025 with three firms submitting proposals. After reviewing and evaluating the proposals and conducting follow-up interviews, we recommend the approval of MPact Collective, Sentient Co., and Propvizer & Partners to complete the District 65 property assessment and generate school property profiles for all current elementary schools and King Arts, Bessie Rhodes, and Park School for \$37,500. The MPact team scored equally high on all evaluation criteria and quoted a considerably lower price for the required scope of work, to be completed by September 4, 2025.

	CBRE	Cushman Wakefield	MPACT/ Sentient/ Propvizer
PRICE	\$110,000	\$140,000	\$37,500